

Is AI (like chat gpt) really bad for the environment, and if so how exactly is it harmful??

Posted by u/okreddituwin • 0 points • 4 comments

I've seen comments around the web alluding to chat gpt destroying the environment and I just saw a post claiming that a homeowner living near an ai data center has had their plumbing destroyed? What do AI and data centers have to do with the environment?

Comments

u/AnorhiDemarche • 2 points • 2025-05-26 12:15 UTC

AI takes a fuckload of processing power. Imagine like a massive warehouse full of computers, servers, networking equipment. When you speak to your alexa **you're speaking to 100 of these warehouses.** that takes a *lot* of electricity. And that's just alexa which is pretty basic.

It takes a separate fuckload of resources to actually train an AI. The water cooling for this alone can fuck up local water supplies.

AI sucks.

u/okreddituwin • 2 points • 2025-05-28 12:41 UTC

Appreciate the response. It makes so much sense but I never thought about the physical aspect of these things. Damn.

u/noggin-scratcher • 1 points • 2025-05-26 12:11 UTC

Data centres consume a lot of electricity, to run all the computers, and the air conditioning involved in keeping them cool. Producing that electricity has an environmental cost when we generate it by burning fossil fuels.

That one homeowner's plumbing appears to have been affected because they draw water from a well, and having a big construction project nearby disturbed the sediment or something.

It's not that AI centres have a unique impact that nothing else does - construction of *any large facility* consuming a lot of power would be similar. But a lot of people view AI as an _unnecessary_ thing to construct, and therefore a waste of resources compared to any benefit of having it.

u/okreddituwin • 1 points • 2025-05-28 12:42 UTC

Appreciate the response, and also there was no article attached about the homeowners, thanks for acknowledging it.

u/wt_anonymous • 1 points • 2025-05-26 12:04 UTC

the (water-based) cooling systems are extremely expensive and consume a lot of water

u/OstebanEccon • 3 points • 2025-05-26 12:02 UTC

they take up an incredible amount of space and electricity